

Business Plan Checklist

The sections a bank, funder or grant panel expects to see, and what each one has to prove.

Executive summary

- ☐ What the business does, in two sentences
- ☐ The opportunity and why now
- ☐ What you are asking for and what it buys

The business

- ☐ Legal structure, registration number and ownership
- ☐ Products or services with prices
- ☐ What makes you different from the alternatives
- ☐ Where you operate and who you need to deliver

Market and customers

- ☐ Who your customer is, described specifically
- ☐ Evidence that they buy: quotes, orders, letters of intent
- ☐ Size of the market you can realistically reach
- ☐ Direct competitors and how you compare on price and quality

Marketing and sales

- ☐ The channels you will use to reach customers
- ☐ Cost of acquiring one customer
- ☐ Sales process from enquiry to payment
- ☐ Marketing budget for the first twelve months

Operations

- ☐ How the work gets delivered, step by step
- ☐ Suppliers and lead times
- ☐ Premises, equipment and systems needed
- ☐ Compliance obligations and who handles them

Management and team

- ☐ Who is involved and what each person is responsible for
- ☐ Relevant experience for the roles
- ☐ Gaps in the team and how you will fill them

Financials

- ☐ Start-up costs and what you are contributing yourself
- ☐ Twelve-month cash-flow forecast
- ☐ Three-year profit projection with stated assumptions
- ☐ Break-even point in units and in pula
- ☐ How and when funding will be repaid

Supporting documents

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation and company extract
- ☐ Tax registration and trade licence
- ☐ Bank statements
- ☐ Quotes for the equipment or stock you are financing
- ☐ Identity documents for directors

Work through this with Coach DK: inspireallconsultancy@gmail.com

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